could recite verses by poets such as Nazrul Islam and Tagore fluently in Bengali. At one time, he was learning Persian as well.[23]

With such a background, his written output appears to have been prodigious, notwithstanding the fact that what he has come down in history to be known for are his revolutionary activities rather than what he wrote during that period. What he wrote, however, opens for us a critically important window into all the formative years of his life as a revolutionary, leading right up the time of his hanging on 23 March 1931. Chaman Lal refers to how '[h]e wrote more than 130 documents in seven years, covering nearly 400 pages' and that '[h]e wrote more than fifty letters, apart from numerous court statements, pamphlets, essays and sketches'. In fact, 'it is believed by many, on the basis of the accounts of one of his comrades in jail, that Bhagat Singh wrote four more books in jail – these manuscripts were smuggled out but are yet to be found'.[24] In the circumstances, any other revolutionary writer would not have failed to have got himself noticed in the West. After all, he pitched himself against Gandhi. He too, like Gandhi, was in search for the soul of India. Yet, Bhagat Singh's writings lie entirely forgotten. His name is barely known, not just in the West, but also in India. It is as if there has been a deliberate act of amnesia amongst the opinion-formers and the intelligentsia. In the Cuban Revolution, the Argentine Marxist revolutionary guerrilla leader Che Guevara, with whom Bhagat Singh is often likened in India, did not meet with the same fate, although he too like Bhagat Singh was an author and military theorist and became for many a countercultural symbol of rebellion and revolt.

The social theorist Professor Vivek Chibber of New York University describes how 'a good case can be made for connection between the anticolonial writings of Cabral and Nkrumah, even those of Fanon, and the socialism of Lenin or Marx'.[25] However, he makes no reference to how the writings of Bhagat Singh did exactly the same, even as Slavoj Zizek refers to Vivek Chibber's book on the back cover as 'the book we were all waiting for . . .'. When Chibber describes how '[f]or much of the twentieth century, trade union and peasant-farmer groups did in fact figure in struggles for